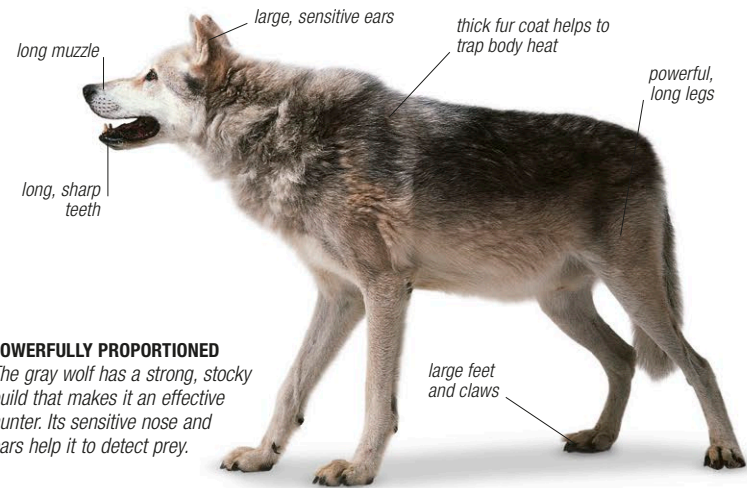


CARE OF THE YOUNG

During the breeding season, which lasts from January to April, the dominant female gives birth to between 1 and 11 pups. After about a month of suckling, pups emerge from the den to receive scraps of food regurgitated by their parents and other pack members. If their food supply has been plentiful, pups will have developed enough to travel with the pack after 3 to 5 months, and by the next breeding season some juveniles will have chosen to leave the pack entirely.

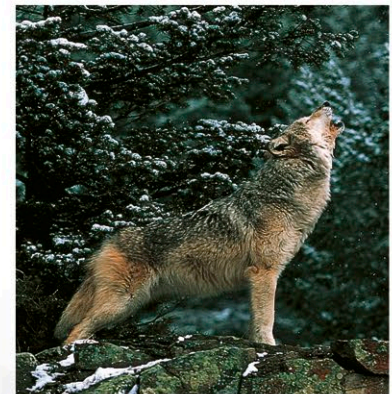


POWERFULLY PROPORTIONED

The gray wolf has a strong, stocky build that makes it an effective hunter. Its sensitive nose and ears help it to detect prey.

PREDATOR AND VICTIM

Although gray wolves can occur close to human settlements, their mythical reputation for ferocity led to their near extermination. Today, most gray wolves live in remote areas, where they hunt herds of large deer or musk oxen.



CALL OF THE WILD

Gray wolves howl to announce their presence and to define and defend their territories. Heard at distances of up to 6 miles (10 km), howling allows rival packs to stay well separated, avoiding confrontation.